

1.1.2 MEI and OCR

MEI is a long established, independent curriculum development body, with a membership consisting almost entirely of working teachers. MEI provide advice and INSET relating to all the curriculum and teaching aspects of the course. It also provides teaching materials, and the accompanying series of textbooks is the product of a partnership between MEI and a major publishing house. A particular feature of this specification is the very substantial website (see Section 7), covering all the various units. Students can access this at school or college, or when working at home. Not only does this help them with their immediate mathematics course; it also develops the skills they will need for independent learning throughout their lives.

OCR's involvement is primarily centred on the assessment, awarding and issuing of results. However, members of the Qualification Team are available to give advice, receive feedback and give general support.

OCR also provides INSET and materials such as Examiners' Reports, mark schemes and past papers.

It is thus a feature of this specification that an exceptional level of help is always available to teachers and students, at the end of the telephone or on-line.